Design Review Report

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Teaching Videos

List each teaching video you watched. For each one, write a real takeaway. What concept clicked for you? What surprised you or challenged an assumption you had? What impressed you about how your teammate demonstrated something? Take this seriously. Your teammates put real effort into these videos to teach you something you did not study yourself.

Video

I watched **JC Jamison**'s video on **Filter vs. Backdrop Performance**.

Takeaway

JC did great on his video! I thought it was really interesting learning about the difference between filter and backdrop filter and how they affect performance on a site. I guess I didn't realize that backdrop filter takes more work for the browser because it has to process everything behind the element too. It was cool to learn how things like blur effects and animations can actually slow down a website if you use too many of them. I also liked how he showed us how to use devtools to see what parts of the page were being repainted. I helped me remember and realize that effects can make a website look really good but it's important to make sure they aren't messing with and making the performance too much or bad for our site.

Video

I watched **Alexis Ruby**'s video on **CSS Path and Mask Image**.

Takeaway

I thought Alexis's video was super interesting! I didn't know you could do so many different things with the shapes of images using css. I have never really used them before. I liked how she showed the difference between clip-path and mask-image and how you can either cut out shapes or make things fade out. I also thought it was cool that you can animate the shapes and make them change when you hover over them. It was fun seeing all the different things she could do with it, and it definitely gave me some ideas of things I could try on my own website.

Video

I watched **Angelique Legaspi**'s video on **Blend Modes**.

Takeaway

One thing I really liked about Angelique's video was how she used different demos to show how blend modes actually work. I especially liked the example with the red and blue circles and how the colors changed where they overlapped depending on the blend mode she used. I didn't know you could do that with just CSS! I also learned more about isolation and how it helps keep certain effects from affecting the rest of the page. Another thing I took away was that we need to be careful with text readability when using these effects. It was a good reminder that making a website look cool is important, but making sure people can actually read and use it is even more important!

Video

I watched **Angelique Legaspi**'s video on **currentColor Patterns**.

Takeaway

One thing that stood out to me from Angelique's video was how much simpler currentColor can make your css. The example with the button and arrow icon was really helpful because when she changed the button color, the arrow automatically matched it. I feel like normally I would have just set those colors separately without even thinking about it. I also liked how she showed it working in both light and dark mode. It made me realize that there are little things you can do in css to save yourself time and make your code easier to work with later on. I will definitely keep this in mind when working on my portfolio.

Video

I watched **JC Jamison**'s video on **Relative Color Syntax**.

Takeaway

I liked JC's video because it helped me understand more about how colors work in css. Since we have been working with colors and dark mode in our portfolios, I thought this was really helpful. I didn't know you could use calc( ) to make colors lighter, darker, or even create complementary colors. I usually just mess around with colors until I find something I like, so it was cool to see a different way to do it. I think this could be really useful when working on my own website and trying to keep my colors consistent.

Video

I watched **Alexis Ruby**'s video on **The contrast-color( ) Function**.

Takeaway

I liked learning about contrast-color( ) because I feel like making sure my colors look good together is something I have been working on a lot in my portfolio. I didn't know css had a way to help choose a text color that stands out against a background. I usually just try different colors until I find something that looks good, so I think this could save me some time. It also reminded me that colors aren't just about making a website look cute, but also making sure everything is easy to read!

Code Reviews

Review at least two teammates' portfolio repositories. Look at their actual code for Choose Topic pages you did not build yourself. Each design review you should choose different teammates to review so that over the course of the semester you cycle through everyone on your team.

Review

I reviewed **Alexis Ruby**'s code for their **CSS Path and Mask Image** page.

What You Found

I liked looking through Alexis's code because I could see all the different shapes she had been trying out with clip-path. I thought it was helpful how she left some of the examples in comments so you could see how to make circles, polygons, and other shapes. One thing I noticed was that she had two clip-path properties, so the second one would override the first. I also noticed that her hover effects were commented out, so they wouldn't actually change the shape right now. It was cool seeing how she experimented with different shapes, and it gave me a better idea of how I could use clip-path in my own projects. I think this is something I want to really try out. I also sent Alexis a quick message about the couple little things I noticed in her code just so she was aware of them on our teams channel. :)

Review

I reviewed **JC Jamison**'s code for their **Color Tokens and Visual Effects** page.

What You Found

I liked looking through JC's code because I noticed how organized he kept all of his css variables. He had different sections for things like spacing, colors, and shadows, which made it pretty easy to follow. One thing I thought was cool was how he used light-dark( ) for his shadow colors so they would automatically change depending on the theme. I also liked how his cards move up a little when you hover over them and the images change from black and white to color. I didn't notice any major issues, but I thought it was interesting that he put his hero styles inside instead of keeping them separate. I think I got some good ideas for keeping my own css more organized and making my visual effects look better so that is good! :)

Check In

How Are You Doing?

I feel like things are going pretty good in this class so far! I have definitely learned a lot about css that I didn't know before. Some of the topics have been a little confusing at first, but once I actually start working with the code and seeing how things work, it makes a lot more sense. I have really enjoyed being able to try new things on my portfolio and see it all come together. I think it is looking pretty good! :) I still feel like there is a lot I can improve on, but I am getting more comfortable with css each week as I work on it. My team has been doing good too, and I don't have any major concerns right now. I'm glad that our one team mate that was mia for a couple weeks is now back! :)